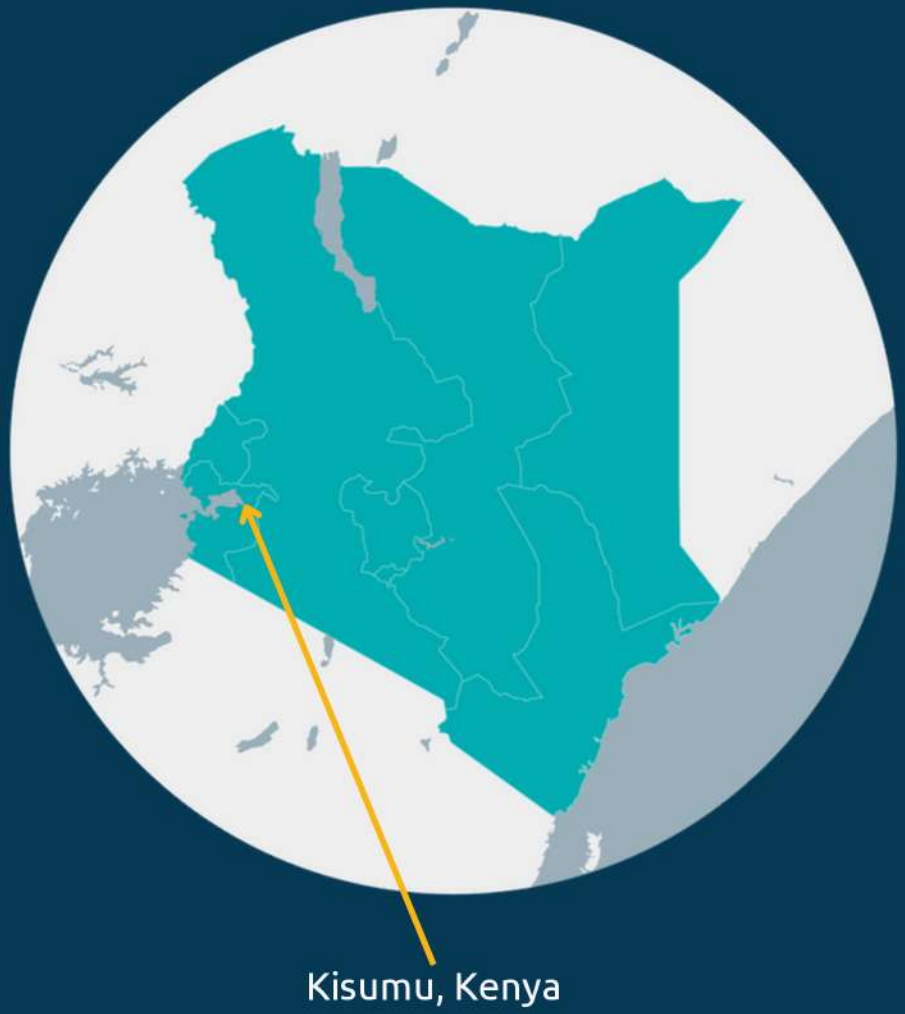


2025 IMPACT REPORT

ABOUT US



Lakehub was founded with the belief that investing in tech education and development of Africa's youth is essential for the growth and progress of the continent, and it is committed to providing the resources and support that these young people need to reach their full potential.

Through **Zone01 Kisumu**, we provide youths from all backgrounds with an opportunity to learn software development from scratch through peer-to-peer activities after which, they are guaranteed employment.

We are based in Kisumu, Kenya.

Mission

Our mission is to decentralize access to technology tools and resources, making them readily available to young people in underserved areas. By providing comprehensive tech education, mentorship programs, and access to cutting-edge technology, we equip young individuals with the skills and resources necessary to succeed in a digital economy

We are the only convener and trainer of young technologists in Kenya's lake region.



A message from our

EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR, DORCAS OWINOH

As 2025 comes to an end, I reflect on a year that strengthened our mission and sharpened our direction. It has been a year of transition, renewed focus, and meaningful progress across both LakeHub and Zone01 Kisumu.

We began the year with clarity during our retreat at Nguge Retreat Center, preparing for a season of rebuilding and repositioning. Our transition out of the KIEP-SKIES program created space for new opportunities to take shape, while our continued collaboration with UNDP supported us in sustaining key community and innovation activities during a critical period.

Zone01 Kisumu reached an important milestone this year. **Twelve months into our peer-to-peer, world-class software development program, our apprentices demonstrated remarkable growth: their collective earnings tripled, global companies expanded their engagement with our teams, and more developers secured real, consistent work**. From AI and blockchain to UI/UX, cloud, and MVP development, their performance has elevated Kisumu's reputation as a hub for exceptional digital talent.

Several apprentices stood out globally, earning a blockchain residency in Singapore, presenting at the One Young World Conference, and gaining a competitive internship with GNOME in Silicon Valley.

We also expanded our ecosystem visibility by contributing to key regional and global platforms, including the Maseno AI Summit, Kenya Blockchain & Crypto Conference, Zetech Innovation Week, and the World CIO 200 Summit.

As we close the year, **we are pleased to see more apprentices entering employment pipelines, securing paid projects, and positioning themselves competitively for long-term careers.** This progress gives us confidence as we prepare to launch a new cohort in 2026, building on stronger systems, clearer processes, and deeper partnerships.

I am also delighted to introduce **Caleb Nyoiro as Co-Executive Director of LakeHub**, a leadership structure that reflects our growth and the scale of impact we aim to achieve moving forward. Caleb has been instrumental in strengthening operations and championing developer success, and his co-leadership positions us well for the next chapter.

To our partners, team, apprentices, board, and community, thank you for your unwavering belief and support. We are proud of how far we have come, and even more excited about what lies ahead.

2025 IN NUMBERS

COHORT I

Our job placement trajectory continued at pace. We have places our apprentices in permanent tech roles both locally and internationally.

40 Developers
Have been placed in permanent paid roles in tech companies

35 Developers
Currently engaged in paid project work at Zone01 Kisumu

3x Increase in Earnings
Apprentices placed in jobs or currently working on projects have seen their income tripple

COHORT II Intake In Progress

Having seen the impact of our pedagogy and it's continued success in job placements, we have continued to attract youths across Kenya.

358
Candidates who have so far participated in the selection piscines

68 Candidates
So far selected for Cohort 2 starting in Q1 2026

21
women selected to join Cohort 2 so far.

22,094
Total Applications

USD 2,500
Highest Paid Salary

USD 450
Avg. Salary



OUR 2025 IMPACT

FROM TRAINEES TO EMPLOYEES - JOB MARKET WELCOMES ZONE01 KISUMU TALENT

Our primary focus this year was to transition trainees from apprenticeship to job placements, a goal that delivered strong results. **By the time of this report, 54% apprentices had secured full-time** roles with companies like Demulla, Technobrain, Civil Society Network, and Berijjam, while an additional 8 candidates were advancing through interviews for front-end and back-end development positions.

Of greater significance though, was the threefold multiplication in our apprentice - now talent - earnings from Kshs. 15,000 (~$115) stipends to an an average salary of Kshs. 54,886 (~$450). This surge in employment during the final phase of their training has confirmed our belief in the merits of our learning mode. This growth demonstrates not only improved technical capacity but also increasing market demand for their skills.

Our positive trajectory extended beyond job placements. **Zone01 Kisumu apprentices stepped confidently onto the global stage, showcasing their talent and representing the region internationally.** Sheila Fana participated in the One Young World Conference in Berlin, while Allan Robinson made significant contributions at the ShanghaiWoo Web3 program in Singapore. These milestones highlight the global competitiveness of our talent.

Interest in Zone01 Kisumu continues to grow. **As we prepared for the launch of Cohort 2, we received thousands of applications from youth eager to join our 2026 Cohort.** Final selections are currently underway at the Rotary Vocational Training Centre, setting the stage for another year of impactful learning and job opportunities.

Finally, **we continue to be recognized for our impact in decentralising and increasing access to tech education and jobs.** Our Executive Director Dorcas Owino showcased the growth of our tech community in Barcelona, Spain at the Mozilla Festival. Our new Co-Director Caleb Nyoiro was named by Kenyans.co.ke as one of the Top 100 Kenyans in 2025. Our Communications Lead, Deril Ouko was invited to speak at Public Relations Society of Kenya Summit and Our Board Chairman, James Odede was named among the Top 40 Under 40 by Business Daily. All these accolades reflect the increased impact of Zone01 Kisumu's model.



Zone01 Kisumu Apprentices Placed In Jobs

Thanks to the transformative 18-month training at Zone01 Kisumu, our apprentices have achieved remarkable career milestones. Here are their impact stories.



Adioz Daniel

Placed at: Big Bold Red Agency
Role: Back End Engineer

Before joining Zone01 Kisumu, Adioz Daniel was a Graphic Designer. He was also one of the senior talents in his cohort, bringing invaluable life experience and a strong sense of responsibility to the learning environment.

Today, we are proud to share that after completing his 18-month, tuition-free tech training, Adioz has secured employment with Big Bold Red Agency in Nairobi. His new role is a perfect blend of his design background and the advanced technical skills he gained at Zone01 Kisumu.

Adioz is now responsible for developing and maintaining a scalable backend system for the agency. He also contributes to the team by building microservices architectures, creating RESTful APIs, and writing clean, maintainable code that supports the agency's growth.

Adioz was successfully placed in October 2025, marking a significant milestone in his professional journey and a testament to the transformative impact of your support.



Quinter Ochieng'

Placed at: KECTIL
Role: Trainer of Trainers

From struggling to access reliable internet and lacking a personal laptop to securing a role with the Knowles Educational and Charitable Trust for International Leadership (KECTIL), Quinter's journey is truly inspiring.

Today, she is a seasoned Full-Stack Developer and UI/UX Designer with over four years of experience. A proud mother to a young daughter, Quinter has been selected by KECTIL as a Trainer of Trainers for its global leadership programme launching in December 2025.

In this new role, Quinter will draw on her strong peer-to-peer learning background to support other trainers in identifying and nurturing exceptional youth in developing countries—young people with the potential to create meaningful, positive change in their communities. Quinter joined KECTIL beginning November 2025

Impact Stories

Zone01 Kisumu Apprentices Placed In Jobs



Valeria Muhembele

Placed at: Berijjam
Role: Backend Developer

Valeria has transformed her career from Computer Science graduate to an accomplished tech professional.

At Zone01 Kisumu, she developed strong technical and mentorship skills that set the foundation for her growth. Her time at Zone01 Kisumu has been instrumental in sharpening her skills and opening new opportunities.

Valeria officially reported to her new role on 1st May 2025 and has since been applying her expertise to create impactful backend systems. Her transition from educator to developer demonstrates that with the right training and determination, career breakthroughs are possible.



David Jesse

Placed at: KECTIL
Role: Trainer of Trainers

The Bachelor of Science in Animal Health graduate has successfully transitioned to become a fullstack developer specialized in building scalable, high-performance applications.

David's growth journey has been evident, He led his team to a first place finish in Google's Build with AI hackathon.

He has been placed at on a Trainer of Trainees role with the Knowles Educational and Charitable Trust for International Leadership (KECTIL) on a Qualcomm-sponsored Intellectual Property (IP) training programme for Kenyan innovators and entrepreneur.



Samuel Omulo

Placed at: Demulla
Role: ICT Officer

Hidden behind his quiet demeanour, Samuel Omulo is a determined, hard working software developer. His dedication to learning code has seen him land a role as ICT Officer at Demulla, a FinTech start up in Kenya.

The role fits his talent perfectly given his track record at Zone01 Kisumu. Samuel led his team to victory in the Code and Cheer Hackathon under the Fintech category.

Samuel Omulo officially reported to his new role on 17th November 2025 after completing his 18-month tuition-free tech training at Zone01 Kisumu.



Clifford Omolo

Placed at: Techno Brain
Role: Software Developer Engineer in Test

Clifford is the latest Zone01 Kisumu talent to secure a permanent role. After a series of interviews with Techno Brain, he has been offered the role of Software Developer Engineer in Test.

In his role, he will be tasked to build scalable web applications and distributed systems.

Clifford Omolo officially reported to his new role on 1st December 2025 after completing his 18-month tuition-free tech training at Zone01 Kisumu.

SHEILA FANA @ ONE YOUNG WORLD SUMMIT IN MUNICH, GERMANY

In November 2025, Sheila Fana, one of Zone01 Kisumu's most outstanding talents, had the honor of representing our community at the One Young World Summit 2025 in Munich, Germany. She connected with young leaders from over 190 countries, exchanging insights and strategies to address pressing global challenges.

The summit focused on key themes including education and skills development, sustainability and circular economy, responsible technology, social cohesion, and global peace and security—all of which have profoundly influenced Sheila's journey as a leading woman in tech.

She also engaged with senior Siemens leaders, who generously shared their expertise in engineering, as well as global changemakers, offering inspiration through their innovations and purpose-driven work.

"Representing Zone01 Kisumu, AGCCI, and EmpowerHer & Allies at the One Young World Summit 2025 was a deeply enriching experience. The summit broadened my leadership perspective, deepened my understanding of global challenges, and empowered me to bring back valuable insights to Zone01 Kisumu." - Sheila Fana

Through interactive panels, corporate sessions, and mentorship engagements, Sheila gained exposure to global perspectives on ethical AI, sustainability frameworks, and youth-led innovation.

These experiences enriched her leadership skills and provided actionable insights to strengthen our programs, particularly in fostering digital skills, innovation, and mentorship for young women in technology.



BUILDING FOR COMMUNITY WITH UNDP

ZONE01 KISUMU DEVELOPERS BUILD CHICHWA PROJECT

Our activities and partnerships are driven by real community impact. This year, we collaborated with UNDP to develop ***Chichwa***, a digital marketplace designed to build agricultural resilience and market access for smallholder farmers in Kenya's ASAL regions.

Seven Zone01 Kisumu apprentices were employed to build Chichwa and to ensure it met the real-world needs of its users. By directly engaging with county officials, the National Disaster Management Authority, cooperatives, and farmers, we gathered critical insights into digital literacy levels and market behaviors.

These findings informed the design of a "mobile-first" solution accessible via USSD, SMS, and the web. Today, the system is fully built and ready for deployment, poised to onboard our partners and transform how farmers in arid regions connect to the economy. The apprentices also received much-needed real-world job experience throughout the project

QUICK FACTS ABOUT CHICHWA PROJECT

$40,000 Total Project Cost

90 Days Project Completed on time

6 Devs Zone01 Kisumu **Software Apprentices earned an average of $2,000** based on a revenue-share model

8 ASALs Chichwa to enhance farmer's market access and resilience in Turkana, Marsabit, Wajir, Garissa, Isiolo, Samburu, Kajiado, Kitui



From Left: Wycliffe and Hannah (Designers), Lornah, Andy, Hezron and Joel Amos and Tomlee Abila (not in picture)



The team led by Project Lead, John Odhiambo conducted a two-week needs assessment across Turkana, Garissa, and Tana River counties.

Impact Stories

Zone01 Kisumu Apprentices Placed In Jobs



Victor Shayo

Placed at: Berijjam

Role: Backend Developer

Fresh from completing his high school education, Shayo taught himself graphic design, which became was his first step into the tech space.

That creative foundation later helped him join Zone 01 Kisumu for the apprentice program, where he deepened his skills through project-based learning and developed a strong interest in product design and user experience.

Currently, Shayo is a UI/UX Developer at Berrijam, where he contributes to creating modern, user-focused digital interfaces while continuing to grow in the design and technology field.



Moses Onyango

Placed at: Berijjam

Role: Backend Developer

A graduate in Computer Technology, Moses built a strong foundation in low-level systems, computer architecture, and hardware-aware programming.

At Zone01 Kisumu program, he transitioned into systems development, gaining practical experience designing and implementing high-performance backend systems using Go and Rust.

Moses has been placed at Berijam AI, where he is contributing to the development of an industry-grade decision tree engine, focused on performance, scalability, and real-world deployment in data-driven applications.



Bernad Okumu

Placed at: Berijjam

Role: Backend Developer

The Bachelor of Science in Health graduate has successfully transitioned to become a fullstack developer specialized in building scalable, high-performance applications..

David's growth journey has been evident, He led his team to a first place finish in Google's Build with AI hackathon.

He has been placed at on a Trainer of Trainees role with the Knowles Educational and Charitable Trust for International Leadership (KECTIL) on a Qualcomm-sponsored Intellectual Property (IP) training programme for Kenyan innovators and entrepreneur.



Thadeus Ogondola

Placed at: Berijjam

Role: DevOps

A former IT intern at the Ministry of Public Service, Gender and Affirmative Action, Thadeus has found his feet at Zone01 Kisumu.

After dedicating himself to learning, Thadeus has earned his role at Berijjam where he packages and deploys applications they have built as a team.

Thadeus has relied on Podman for containerization, alongside shell scripts to manage the application stack. Python, which is a core skill he learnt at Zone01 Kisumu, is also part of the workflow, helping the team automate various deployment and packaging tasks.

Impact Stories

Zone01 Kisumu Apprentices Placed In Jobs



Rodney Ochieng'

Placed at: Berijjam

Role: DevOps

A Logistics & Supply Chain Management graduate, Rodney pivoted into software engineering through Zone01 Kisumu.

Through the Zone01 program, Rodney gained hands-on experience in backend development with Go, Rust, and Python.

He was later placed on the Berrijam project, where he expanded into DevOps, data analysis, MLOps, and infrastructure engineering, working with containerization, Linux systems, and scalable data workflows.



Hillary Okello

Placed at: Berijjam

Role: Frontend Developer

With a background in Construction Management, Hilary gained hands-on experience coordinating projects and solving practical problems. This shaped his structured, analytical approach to engineering.

His training emphasized creating reliable, scalable systems and understanding how different layers of an application work together.

At Berrijam, Hilary works as a backend developer, contributing to applications that make AI accessible to users across diverse industries. He uses Python and FastAPI.



Caleb Madara

Placed at: Berijjam

Role: Frontend Developer

Raymond Caleb's path to becoming a Full Stack Software Engineer has strengthened our belief in our learning model.

Raymond joined Zone01 Kisumu with little coding skills. 18 months later, Raymond has developed world-class coding skills in backend development, API design, authentication systems, and AI-powered applications.

Raymond has been placed at Berijjam AI as a backend developer optimizing codebases and building interactive, data-driven applications using Django, JavaScript, and modern web technologies.



Nicholas Otieno

Placed at: Berijjam

Role: Back End Developer

The Bachelor of Science in Health graduate has successfully transitioned to become a fullstack developer specialized in building scalable, high-performance apps.

Nicholas has expanded his skillset from microbial genomics and bioinformatics analysis into software development, high-performance computing, and infrastructure engineering.

Nicholas currently applies his expertise in Python, Rust, and Linux-based environments at Berijjam where he is combining biological insight with computational and statistical methodologies to support advanced microbial research.

ANN MAINA – DRIVING AFRICA'S WEB3 FUTURE

Ann Maina always dreamed of success but she never imagined that she could become a major voice of influence in Web3 across Africa.

In the last quarter, Ann Maina embarked on a journey across Africa's Web3 landscape, turning ideas into impact. From Kilifi's ETHSafari, where she connected with innovators creating decentralized AI and fintech solutions, to the Wakawell x IOM UN Migration Hackathon, where she led the development of Salama, an AI travel companion supporting safe migration for athletes, Ann's work has consistently combined technology with purpose. **Her efforts earned her the Most Valuable Player Award, a recognition she attributes to the foundation built at Zone01 Kisumu, where her tech journey began.**

In Kampala, she pitched Protokol Afrika, a vision for on-chain, user-friendly Web3 interfaces, and in Kigali, she engaged with top blockchain leaders, shaping discussions on digital money and crypto adoption. Across every stage, **Ann's story illustrates how talent, mentorship and community she found at Zone01 Kisumu can drive Africa's tech ecosystem forward.**

Away from her Web3 exploits, Ann Maina currently works as a UI/UX developer for Rishiflow where her earnings have tripled since she joined Zone01 Kisumu in 2024.



Zone01 Kisumu Talents Take Up Leading Global Roles



Malika Asman
Placed at: GNOME Foundation, California, USA

Malika's has overcome great personal loss and self-doubt to become an inspiration to women and girls in tech as well as one of the highest earning Zone01 Kisumu talents.

Malika has landed a prestigious ambassadorial role at GNOME Foundation, a role she has taken to like duck to water.

She has described the internship as an important step in her open-source career and acknowledged the valuable support received from the GNOME Foundation community. She remains committed to advancing the project and enhancing the overall performance and user experience of GNOME Papers.



Stellla Oiro
AWS Community Builder

Stella Oiro has joined Afrilabs as a Consultant on the AI Bias Reduction and Inclusive Data Generation Engine (AI BRIDGE) project.

So far, Stella's technical content as an AWS Community Builder has reached over 13,000 developers across 47 published articles, creating comprehensive documentation that transforms complex cloud architectures and system design into actionable implementation guides for production environments.

Zone01 Kisumu community has witnessed her commitment to empowering the next generation of African innovators building in AI ethics, cloud computing, and healthcare technology. We wish Stella success.



Cheryl Owalla
Polytick.us, US and Pakistan

Cheryl Owalla has joined Polytick.us, an AI and data company operating in the US and Pakistan. Cheryl works on predictive analytics, machine learning models, and data-driven solutions.

Cheryl also leads community initiatives as a Developer Advocate for Polkadot She has also been named in the illustrious Unstoppable Women of Web3, a group dedicated to training the next generation of talent and making Web3 accessible, inclusive and action-oriented

Zone01 Kisumu community has witnessed her commitment to empowering the next generation of African innovators building in AI, data science, and decentralized systems. We wish Cheryl success.



Allan Kamau
Polkadot

The allure to continue building the Polkadot Community in Africa was too strong for Allan Robinson Kamau to resist. He joins Polkadot community as Africa Community Advocate.

As part of Polkadot Africa's Advocate Program, Allan will Co-host developer events and workshops, connecting local builders to global opportunities, spread awareness about Polkadot's mission and technology.

This new role follows his month-long ShanhaiWoo residency in Singapore where he spent time learning and contributing to Web3 projects. Allan's passion for Web3 has been nurtured at Zone01 Kisumu.

Impact Stories

Zone01 Kisumu Apprentices Placed In Jobs



Teddy Ogola Siaka
Back End Developer
Rishi Flow

Teddy Ogola Siaka is yet another quiet but strong-willed developer. A man of few word but plenty of grit, he has managed to carve out his niche as a rising talent in fullstack development.

Travelling all the way from Kenya Methodist University in Meru (580 kms away) to join Zone01 Kisumu, Teddy has made himself feel at home by consistently turning up to work and learning scalable algorithms, SPAs, and concurrent systems using Goroutines.

Teddy is working at Rishi Flow as a back end developer implementing AI-enabled systems that simplify workflow.



Rodgers Kaunda
Placed at: RishiFlow
Role: Mobile Developer

Rodgers has always loved numbers. A keen mathematician and chess player, his background in statistics has allowed him to use data-driven insights to develop tech solutions.

At Zone01 Kisumu, Rodgers has honed his skills in the field of mobile applications development, creating solutions for clients and working alongside his peers to create products that drive meaningful societal change.

At Rishiflow, Rodgers is integrating and deploying scalable mobile applications. He ensures stability and long-term maintainability, translating the commitment to technical excellence into robust user experience.



Aoron Ochieng'
Placed at: RishiFlow
Role: Mobile Developer

The Information Technology graduate was already dabbling with various tech languages before he joined Zone01 Kisumu.

At Zone01 Kisumu, he gained practical experience through various projects where he collaborated with diverse teams to design and implement innovative solutions.

Aaron has been placed at Rishiflow where he works as a backend developer, focusing on building robust services and contributing to applications that integrate AI. He trains models with retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) capabilities, making intelligent systems more accessible and impactful across industries.



Ferdynand Odhiambo
Placed at: CTEX Technologies
Role: Software Developer

Ferdynand, who spent hours online teaching himself code and searching for opportunities till he discovered Zone01 Kisumu, has applied himself beyond expectations.

Throughout his time at Zone01 Kisumu, he has dedicated himself to understanding various technologies like Django, Laravel and Go. Ferdynand also honed his passion for technical writing through Dev.to.

Ferdynand has been placed at CTEX Technologies as a Software Developer where he designs systems, gathers project information, and models tech solutions for various clients.

Impact Stories

Zone01 Kisumu Apprentices Placed In Jobs



Vincent Omondi

Placed at: Berijjam
Placed at: Project Manager

Vincent joined Zone01 Kisumu as a software development apprentice, eager to turn a passion for problem-solving into real-world impact.

Through the 18-month apprenticeship, Vincent developed full-stack development skills through projects, quads, hackathons and collaborative peer-to-peer learning, building a strong technical foundation while cultivating an interest in team coordination and strategic thinking.

Vincent is a Project Manager at Berrijam AI. He leads cross-functional teams in developing a no-code AI platform that democratizes data analytics for non-programmers.



Seth Odhiambo

Role: Front End Developer
Placed at: Berijjam

After college, Seth joined AppNex Company Ltd, where he gained his first professional experience in the tech industry.

That foundation led him to Zone 01 Kisumu where he deepened his skills across multiple technologies including React, Next.js, Django, and languages like Go, Python, and Rust.

Currently, Seth is a Fullstack Engineer and Co-founder of Evarest Technologies, a software engineering company partnering with Berrijam Company Ltd and Rokkni Foods, where he contributes to creating modern, user-focused digital solutions while continuing to grow in the software engineering and technology field.



Hezborn Shikuku

Role: Front End Developer
Placed at: BaruchSoft Ltd

Hezborn began his journey in IT through freelance work, handling software and hardware installations for small businesses. Driven by a desire to grow, he joined Zone 01 Kisumu, where he strengthened his expertise in software development practices and the full development lifecycle through project-based learning.

Hezborn currently works at BaruchSoft Ltd, implementing, testing, and deploying frontends using Angular (TypeScript) and React to help clients achieve their business goals. Collaborating closely with his team, he has honed strong communication and teamwork skills, which are central to delivering high-quality software solutions.



Godwin Ouma

Role: Communications
Placed at: CSO Network

Ouma's tech journey began with digital literacy training and hands-on experience at a cybercafé, where he supported his community with document design and online services.

He joined Zone01 Kisumu in 2024. So far he has continued to develop skills in Go, JavaScript, Python, TypeScript, and Solidity, and explored blockchain and community-focused digital tools.

He has been placed at Civil Society Organization Network as an Associate, building internal tech tools, managing digital platforms, and producing media content.

PARTNERING THROUGH EVENTS IN Q4



AJIRA DIGITAL - ANOTHER PATHWAY TO EARNING

To provide more pathways for our talent to enter the job market, we have partnered with **Ajira Digital,** the free Government of Kenya program open to all young Kenyans who are looking to make a dignified livelihood from digital and digitally-enabled work opportunities

Ajira Digital introduces talent to macro online work platforms such as Upwork which have redefined online work.

While our goal at Zone01 Kisumu is to place every talent in long-term tech roles, online work offers freedom, flexibility and short-term agility that allows our talent to earn extra from gig work.



NATIONAL DATA GOVERNANCE POLICY TOWN HALL

We are proud to have supported the development of Kenya's National Data Governance Policy in Q4.

The town hall deliberations were led by the Ministry of Information, Communication, and the Digital Economy, Total Information Management, and LakeHub Foundation.

County ICT Directors leading public data management (including Kisumu, Vihiga, Kisii, and Busia), Senior Data Protection Officers, young Cybersecurity Developers from Zone01 Kisumu, seasoned Advocates, Creative Entrepreneurs, and members of the public brought such a rich mix of expertise and experience to the discussion.



AFRICA'S TALKING COMMUNITY & GOOGLE LAUNCHPAD

A key highlight of Q4 (and the year) was hosting a three day hackathon in partnership with Africa's Talking and Google.

Africa's Talking is the leading API platform for software developers in Africa building SMS, USSD, Voice and Airtime applications.

Zone01 Kisumu developers were joined by other devs from across Kenya in workshops geared toward helping participants refine and finalize their capstone project strategies.

Zone01 Kisumu developers were able to elevate their knowledge from foundational cloud and AI concepts into advanced frameworks, API integrations, and offline-ready solutions.



SHOWCASING 12 YEARS OF INNOVATION AT MOZFEST



This year, LakeHub took the Kisumu ecosystem to the global stage at MozFest Barcelona. Through a unique art installation, we visualized twelve years of data, development, and growth, turning our organizational history into a tangible experience for attendees. This "living archive" highlighted the resilience and vibrancy of the community we have nurtured since our inception

"LakeHub is more than a hub for so many of us, I am so proud to have been part of this journey in small and big ways. 12 years is no mean feat and am glad the work through Mozilla Festival was seen beyond the bustling streets and wavy sounds of Kisumu. Good job Dorcas Owinoh and Deril Ouko and the entire team of LakeHub & Zone01 Kisumu"



To our partners and funders: this legacy is yours as much as it is ours. Your support is the engine behind every line of code written and every career launched. Thank you for believing in our vision and for helping us prove that innovation in Africa is robust, sustainable, and impactful.

Impact Stories

Zone01 Kisumu Apprentices Placed In Jobs



Josephine Opondo
Placed at: BongoHub
Role: Project Manager

With a background in German language studies, Josephine began her career working on freelance German-language projects. Her freelance work gradually introduced her to the technology space.

Josephine joined Zone01 Kisumu, where she deepened her technical and project coordination capabilities through hands-on, project-based learning.

Josephine is now a Technical Project Manager at Bongo Hub, building and managing AI-driven products, operating at the intersection of product development, engineering, and strategy.



Emmanuel Barsulai
Placed at: BongoHub
Role: Backend Developer

After completing his BSc in IT, Emmanuel joined Zone 01 Kisumu and went all in on backend development, mastering Go, Node.js, and Ruby through hands-on, project-based learning.

That foundation has turned Emmanuel into an engineer who builds APIs designed for scale, writes queries optimized for speed, and architects systems that just work.

Today, Emmanuel is a Backend Developer at Bongohub, where he builds and maintains the production-ready backend system while staying active in open source and the developer community.



Abraham King'oo
Placed at: BongoHub
Role: Backend Developer

Abraham began his journey into tech after joining a coding boot camp, where he taught himself programming and built the foundation for his career.

That foundation helped him join Zone 01 Kisumu for the apprentice program, where he deepened his skills through project-based learning and developed a strong interest in backend development.

Currently, Abraham is a Backend Developer at BongoHub, where he contributes to building reliable, scalable systems. He works primarily with Ruby on Rails and develops backend services using Django to grow his expertise and impact in the technology field.



John Odhiambo
Placed at: UNDP/Chichwa
Role: Project Manager

John always looked for opportunities that went beyond working with computers to creating products with real impact.

This ambition led him to join Zone01 Kisumu, where the peer-driven learning model expanded his perspective on software engineering and strengthened his ability to think creatively, collaborate intentionally, and grow into a well-rounded developer.

John is the Technical Project Manager for UNDP's Chichwa project, where he blends his technical expertise with project strategy and a deep understanding of community needs.

Impact Stories

Zone01 Kisumu Apprentices Placed In Jobs



Hannah Apiko

Placed at: UNDP Chichwa

Role: UI/UX Designer

Hannah's Diploma in ICT, achieved through sweat and hard work, was not enough to earn her a job in tech.

Hannah joined Zone01 Kisumu, where she has built a strong foundation in programming languages including Go, JavaScript, and Rust through hands-on projects. Hannah also developed a keen interest in UI/UX design, exploring how digital products look, feel, and function from a user's perspective.

Hannah applies this combination of skills as a UI/UX Designer on the UNDP-supported Chichwa project, a digital agricultural management platform.



Lornah Akoth

Placed at: UNDP Chichwa

Role: Front End Developer

Lorna completed her undergraduate degree in Computer Science Engineeeing.

She has since been in the development space at Lakehub and transitioned to Zone01 Kisumu. At Zone 01 Kisumu she continues to upskill and is specializing in backend development of systems that are reliable and fault-tolerant.

Her recent undertaking has been collaborating on Chichwa's frontend development. Aditionally, Lorna is working on an internal microservice Java opensource project employing GRPC protocals, Jenkins and containarization with docker.



Joel Amos

Placed at: UNDP Chichwa

Role: Front End Developer

Joel joined Zone01 Kisumu while still in campus and immersed himself in full-stack engineering, strengthening his skills in design workflows, frontend development, backend systems, and DevOps.

While at Zone01 Kisumu, Joel has, through hands-on project-based learning, mastered Go and modern JavaScript frameworks. He has also become an exceptional team player. He also leads the scrabble club at Zone01 Kisumu.

Joel is a UI/UX Designer on the UNDP Chichwa project, where he designs system architecture and leads the development of Progressive Web Apps.



Wycliffe Alphus Onyango

Placed at: UNDP Chichwa

Role: DevOps

Wycliffe's journey reflects steady growth and continuous learning. His studies in Microprocessor Technology and Instrumentation equipped him with a strong foundation in critical thinking, problem-solving, and engineering.

Wycliffe joined Zone01 Kisumu, where intensive, project-based learning expanded his capabilities and nurtured a growing interest in automation and modern infrastructure.

Wycliffe is advancing in DevOps and cloud engineering working on UNDP's Chichwa, building reliable systems and delivering impactful technological solutions.

Impact Stories

Zone01 Kisumu Apprentices Placed In Jobs



Andrew Osindo

Placed at: UNDP Chichwa
Role: Project Manager

Andrew's journey into software development is rooted in a fundamental appreciation for structured data and critical systems, initially cultivated during his studies in health and information technology.

A jovial, unapologetically loud and bubbly talent, Zone01 Kisumu has witnessed his personality shine. A keen creative, his contributions to Zone01 Kisumu has transcended code.

Andrew has been placed at UNDP Chichwa project where his focussed on building Chichwa's reliable systems ready to scale alongside rapidly growing user bases.



Hezron Okwach

Placed at: UNDP Chichwa
Role: Front End Developer

A graduate with technical skills who hadn't secured a job befitting his skills found a home at Zone01 Kisumu.

Joining Zone01 Kisumu meant that he developed his already strong passion for building accessible, impactful technology solutions for underserved communities.

Hezron serves as a Backend Developer at UNDP Chichwa Project where he leverages Django and Python to build reliable, scalable, and inclusive systems for farmers in Arid and Semi-Arid counties in Kenya.



Tomlee Abila

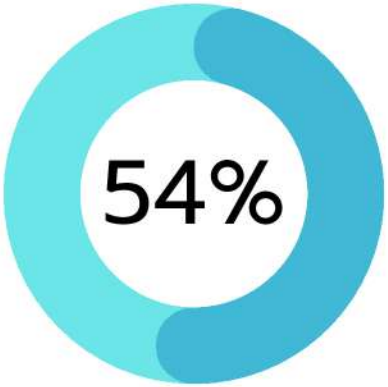
Placed at: UNDP Chichwa
Role: Mobile Developer

The Baraton University alumni's professional growth has been significantly shaped by his time at Zone01 Kisumu.

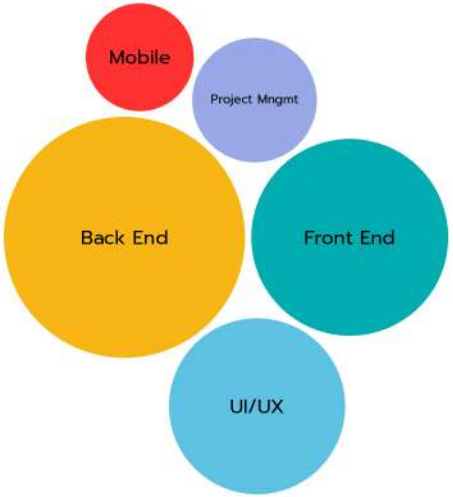
During his time at Zone01 Kisumu, he gained solid experience in both backend and frontend development, working with languages such as Go, Rust, Java, and Python. The project-based learning approach strengthened his technical discipline and problem-solving skills

Tomlee has been placed at Chichwa, UNDP project, where he works as a backend developer on core system functionalities. He is also a co-founder of the Code and Circuit IoT community.

Talents Placed in Jobs



Jobs Cluster



STATEMENT OF EXPENDITURE FOR THE YEAR 2025

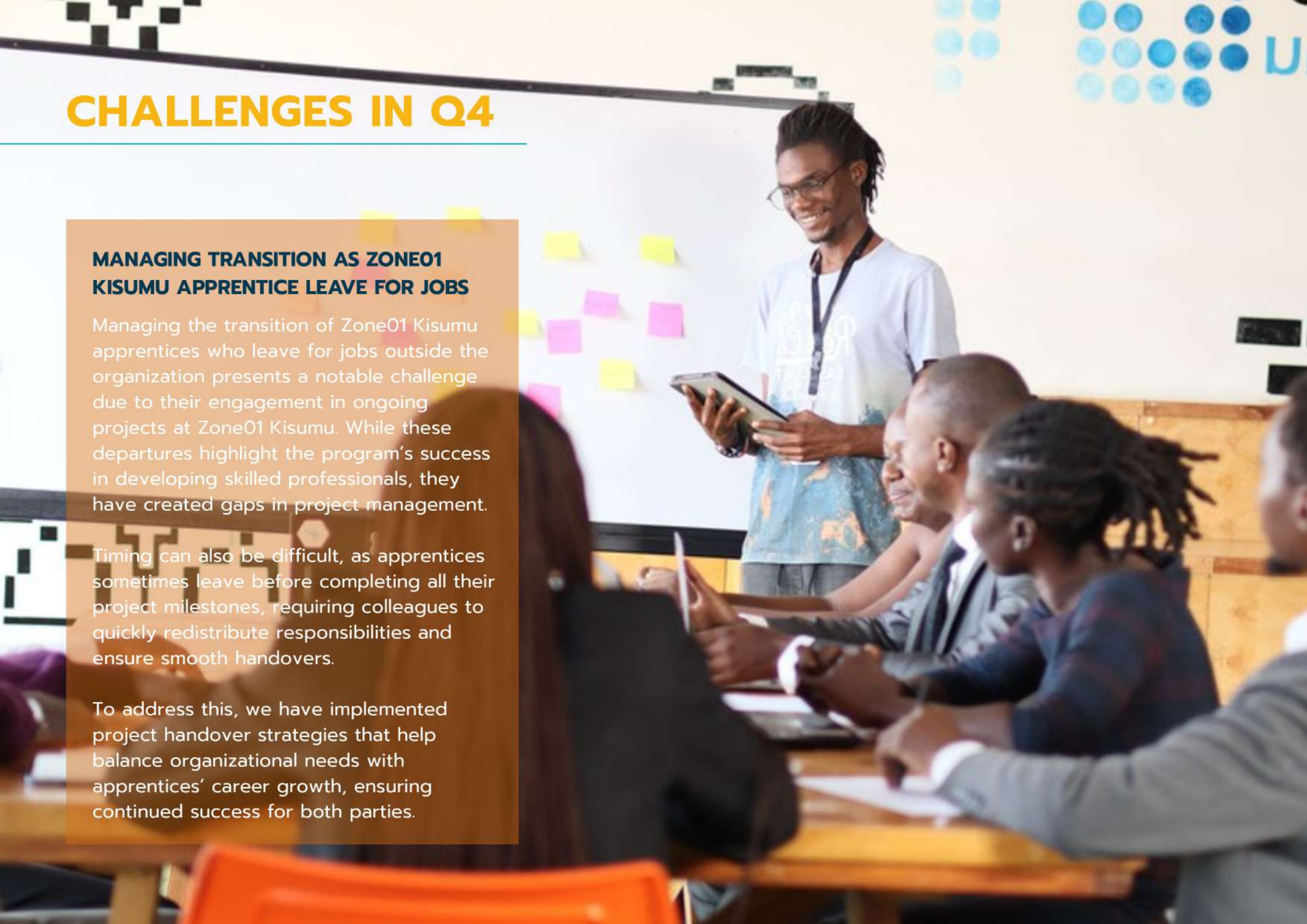
The negative variance of 16.5% under Operational expenses resulted from underutilization of the marketing budget and adminstrative costs. The planned marketing and recruitment activities were postponed to next year which makes the actual expenditure less than projected, leading to reduced spending in this category.

The positive variance of 9.48% under programmatic cost is as a result of the expenditure on repairs, maintenance and need for additioanl software subscription that were not anticipated during the budgeting.

	Budget	Jan-Dec '25	Variance	Variance %
Income				
Grant Inflows		**440,168.55**		
Other earnings (Project Income)		**42,218.16**		
Total Revenue	**462,997**	**482,386.71**	**19,389.71**	4.19%
Expenses				
Program Expenses	**210,452**	**230,395**	**19,943**	9.48%
Operational Expenses	**252,545**	**210,865**	**-41,680**	-16.50%
Total Expenses	**462,997**	**441,260**	**-21,737**	-4.69%

All currency is in USD($)

CHALLENGES IN Q4

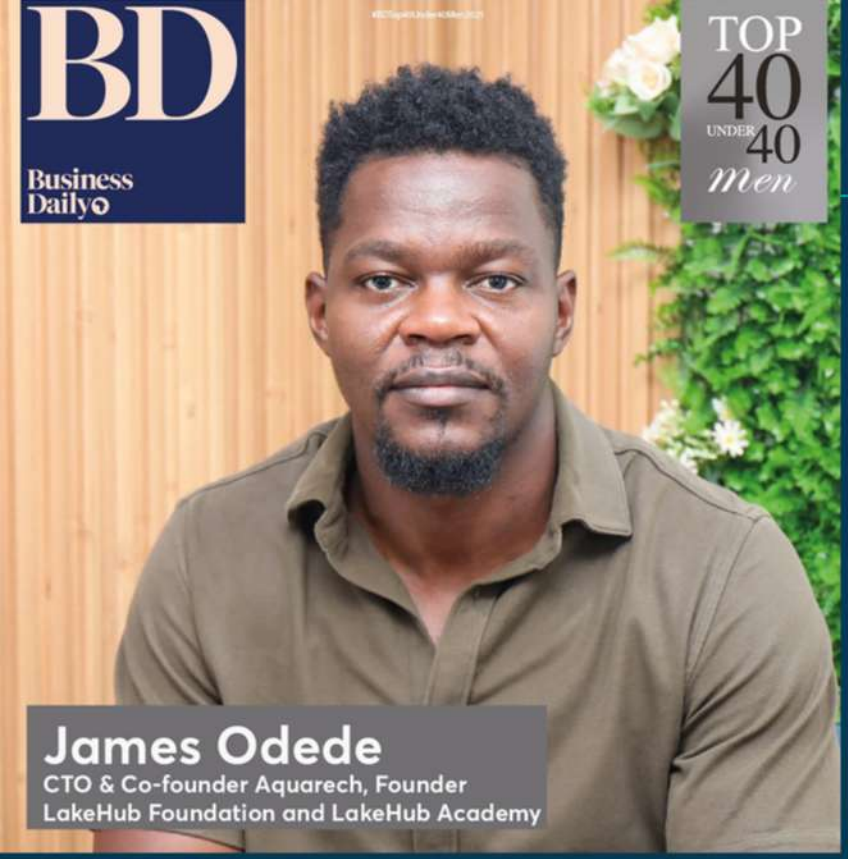


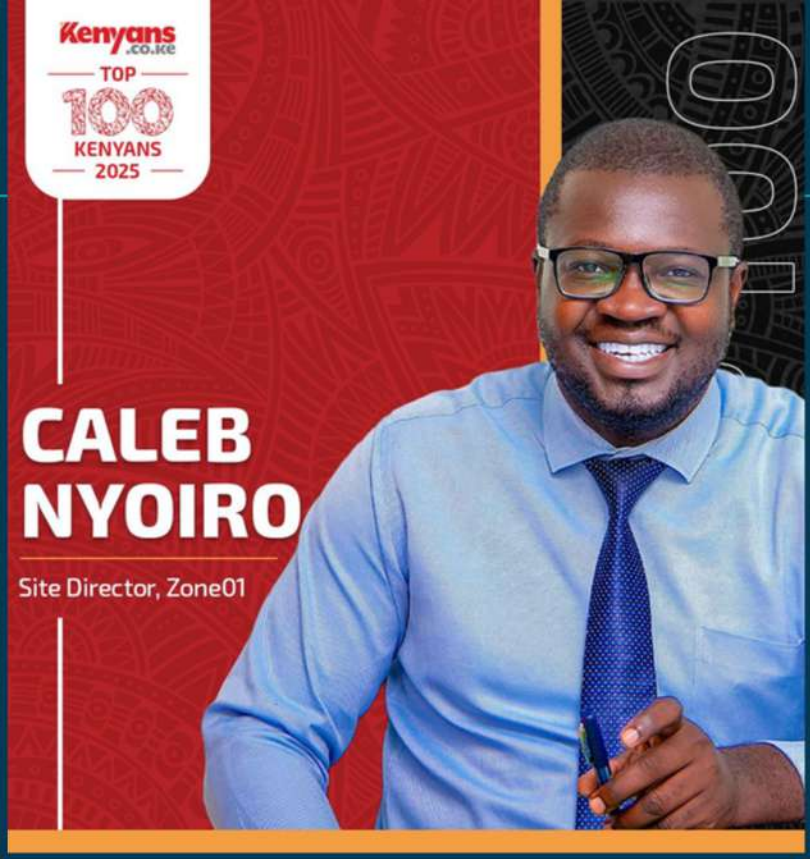
MANAGING TRANSITION AS ZONE01 KISUMU APPRENTICE LEAVE FOR JOBS

Managing the transition of Zone01 Kisumu apprentices who leave for jobs outside the organization presents a notable challenge due to their engagement in ongoing projects at Zone01 Kisumu. While these departures highlight the program's success in developing skilled professionals, they have created gaps in project management.

Timing can also be difficult, as apprentices sometimes leave before completing all their project milestones, requiring colleagues to quickly redistribute responsibilities and ensure smooth handovers.

To address this, we have implemented project handover strategies that help balance organizational needs with apprentices' career growth, ensuring continued success for both parties.









IN THE NEWS

2025 draws to a close with a quadruple dose of recognition for the impact that LakeHub and Zone01 Kisumu has had in our community. First, LakeHub Co-Founder, James Odede was named among the Top 40 Under 40 Men by Business Daily alongside notable names like Grammy Award-winning artist Bien-Aimé Baraza and Olympic 800M Champion Emmanuel Wanyonyi.

Co-Executive Director Caleb Nyoiro was then listed by Kenyans.co.ke as one of the 100 individuals, alongside marathon greats such as the greatest Marathoner in the world, Eliud Kipchoge, who shaped Kenya's story in 2025.

Earlier in November, Dorcas Owino, LakeHub Co-Founder and Executive Director showcased an installation about our tech community at the Mozilla Festival in Barcelona.

Lastly, LakeHub/Zone01 Kisumu's Communications Lead, Deril Ouko, was invited to present a case study on Crisis Communications and be an expert panelist at the 20th Annual Public Relations Society Summit.

These recognitions are a testament to and appreciation of the efforts that Zone01 Kisumu has made by providing youth access to tech skills and fighting youth unemployment

MEET OUR TEAM

At the heart of **LakeHub** is a team dedicated to empowering youth through transformative tech education. Our team is committed to building a future where opportunity is driven by skills, innovation, and collaboration. We foster a supportive, inclusive environment that nurtures talent and drives lasting social impact across Western Kenya and beyond.



Dorcas Owinoh
Executive Director



Caleb Nyoiro
Co-Executive Director



Paul Oguda
Head of Tech



Lydiah Ojowi
Finance Manager



Torsten Kremser
Partnerships



Deril Ouko
Comms Lead



Bellah Oyucho
Tech Mentor



Stacy Dina
Tech Mentor



Alpha Omondi
Tech Mentor



Daisy Achieng
Comms Associate

THANK YOU

To all our partners for trusting us with their tremendous and generous financial, in-kind donations, support, collaboration, and jobs that have helped us impact lives in 2025. Without you, every activity we have performed and achieved until now would not have been possible.

Our Funding Partners

PFE PARTNERS FOR EQUITY AUSTRALIA

Livelihood Impact Fund

Segal Family Foundation

King Baudouin Foundation
Working together for a better society

KIEP | SKIES

Our Implementing Partners

Talent

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Cités et Gouvernements Locaux Unis d'Afrique
CGLU AFRIQUE

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BONGO HUB

Berrijam

BBR

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CTEX

technoprise

GNOME

Demulla



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